are designed the other way around with the pins being on the processor and holes being present on the socket. Both Intel and AMD make use of both sockets for their processors, Intel uses LGA for their desktop processors and AMD uses ZIF for their desktop processors. The current socket lineup for Intel consists of - LGA 1155 / LGA 1150 / LGA 2011. And for AMD - AM3+ / FM1 / FM2. Sockets are not always backwards compatible. One query we've received is if the biggest socket (LGA 2011) supports all lower socket processors. The answer is a strong resounding NO! Never put a processor in any socket other than the one it was made for.

2. RAM sockets

RAM sockets are placed as close as possible to the CPU socket since the latency of communicating with the RAM affects CPU processor. Usually one finds 2 or 4 RAM slots on a motherboard. This is due to the support for dual channel and quad channel memory configurations. In the previous generation of processors we even had triple channel configurations so those motherboards featured 3 or 6 slots. With each improvement in RAM technology, the density of RAM modules increases and the capacity that each slot can support(this is decided by the CPU architecture and BIOS) also increases. Currently we have RAM modules that have a capacity for 8 GB, though 16 GB DIMMs have been announced for DDR4 modules starting early next year. Also RAM frequency support varies with motherboards.

Certain motherboards in order to preserve compatibility come with 4 RAM slots out of which 2 support DDR2 and the other 2 support DDR3. RAM modules have notches on either side that help lock them onto the